Chapter 27

First Aid and Emergencies

1. Providing First Aid
2. CPR and First Aid for Shock and Choking
3. Responding to Other Common Emergencies
4. Emergency Preparedness

Lesson 1 — Providing First Aid

First aid is immediate, temporary care given to an ill or injured person until professional medical care arrives. The Three Cs: **Check** (scene safety + victim), **Call** (911), **Care** (provide first aid with permission).

Universal precautions — treating all body fluids as potentially infectious — protect you from HIV, hepatitis B, and other pathogens. Always wear gloves if available; wash hands thoroughly after giving first aid.

Lesson 2 — CPR and First Aid for Shock and Choking

Updated CPR Guidelines — Major Changes Since 2011

Hands-Only CPR	The AHA now recommends compression-only CPR for untrained bystanders with adults. No rescue breaths required. Push hard and fast on the center of the chest — 100–120 times/minute ('Stayin' Alive' tempo).
C-A-B Sequence	Current guidelines: Compressions first, then Airway, then Breathing (old sequence was A-B-C).
Compression depth	At least 2 inches for adults; about 1.5 inches for infants
Ratio	30 compressions : 2 breaths (single rescuer); 15:2 for two rescuers with children

Naloxone (Narcan) — Critical New Addition

The 2024 AHA/ARC guidelines added naloxone administration as a first-aid recommendation for suspected opioid overdose. Signs of overdose: blue or gray lips, very slow or stopped breathing, will not wake up, limp body, pinpoint pupils. **Call 911**, begin CPR if not breathing, administer naloxone if available.

Lesson 3 — Responding to Other Common Emergencies

P.R.I.C.E. for sprains and strains: **P**rotect, **R**est, **I**ce (wrapped; never directly on skin), **C**ompress, **E**levate. For poisoning: call **Poison Control at 1-800-222-1222** immediately — do NOT induce vomiting unless directed.

Lesson 4 — Emergency Preparedness

Know the difference: **Watch** = conditions favorable for severe weather (prepare). **Warning** = severe weather imminent (take action NOW). Build an emergency survival kit for 72+ hours: water (1 gal/person/day), shelf-stable food, first-aid kit, flashlights, battery radio, phone charger, cash, important documents.

Chapter Vocabulary

Lesson 1

First aid	The immediate, temporary care given to an ill or injured person until professional medical care can be provided
Good Samaritan laws	Statutes that protect individuals who provide reasonable emergency care in good faith
Universal precautions	The practice of treating all blood and body fluids as potentially infectious

Lesson 2

Chain of survival	The sequence of actions (call 911, CPR, AED, advanced care, post-arrest care) that maximize survival chances
CPR (cardiopulmonary resuscitation)	An emergency procedure combining chest compressions and rescue breathing to circulate blood and oxygen
Hands-Only CPR	Compression-only CPR recommended by the AHA for untrained bystanders responding to adult cardiac arrest
Shock	A life-threatening condition in which circulation is inadequate to supply oxygen to body tissues

Lesson 3

Fracture	A break in a bone; a medical emergency
Concussion	A jarring brain injury caused by a blow or jolt to the head; always warrants medical evaluation
Poison	Any substance that causes injury, illness, or death when it enters the body

Lesson 4

Hurricane	A tropical storm with sustained winds of 74+ mph
Tornado	A violent rotating column of air extending to the ground; seek the lowest interior room immediately
Emergency survival kit	A collection of supplies needed to sustain a household for 72+ hours during or after an emergency